SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

9 August 2021 · Shift 3

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. COMPLETE

(A) plentiful
(B) bulky
(C) partial
(D) vacant

Q.2

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The prisoner was very upset and angry and there was _____ in her voice.

(A) bitterness
(B) thickness
(C) stillness
(D) eagerness

Q.3

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. We've decided to spend our time play online games as we will not go out on a vacation this year.

(A) not go out
(B) play online games
(C) to spend our time
(D) we've decided

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) converse
(B) convert
(C) convean
(D) convent

Q.5

Select the option which means the same as the group of words given. One who cannot be reformed or changed

(A) invincible
(B) infallible
(C) incorrigible
(D) indelible

Q.6

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, select the one that gives their correct order. A. It becomes evident from their stories that their desire to succeed became their driving force, their purpose in life. B. We read many stories of people who overcame serious disabilities. C. This is what made a paralytic, Wilma Rudolf, win three gold medals on the track in the 1960 Olympics. D. They wanted to prove to themselves that they could do it in spite of all odds - and they did it.

(A) BADC
(B) ACBD
(C) ADBC
(D) BCDA

Q.7

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A person who pretends to have morals and beliefs that he or she doesn't believe in

(A) communal
(B) versatile
(C) hypocrite
(D) radical

Q.8

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. We mow the lawn once every month.

(A) The lawn was mowed once every month.
(B) The lawn has been mowed once every month.
(C) The lawn is mowed once every month.
(D) The lawn will be mowed once every month.

Q.9

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. They were covered with mud from head to foot. B. Two men were fighting, crying out and cursing, at the bottom of the ditch. C. "Stop that!" shouted the sergeant. D. Three or four soldiers, holding torches, were standing around a ditch.

(A) DCBA
(B) BDAC
(C) DBAC
(D) BACD

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Ashoka was one of "the greater king" of India.

(A) the more great kings
(B) the greater kings
(C) No substitution
(D) the greatest kings

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. NONDESCRIPT

(A) distinguished
(B) ordinary
(C) vague
(D) common

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A blessing in disguise

(A) something good that isn't recognised at first
(B) someone who comes disguised
(C) a person who blesses others quietly
(D) an event that is unknown

Q.13

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The supervisor said to the staff, "Make sure that every room is disinfected properly."

(A) The supervisor instructed the staff to make sure that every room had been disinfected properly.
(B) The supervisor instructed the staff to make sure that every room was being disinfected properly.
(C) The supervisor instructs the staff to make sure that every room is disinfected properly.
(D) The supervisor instructed the staff to make sure that every room was disinfected properly.

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Needle in a haystack

(A) Someone having vast opportunities
(B) Someone in trouble
(C) Something impossible to find
(D) Something very trivial

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. COMPLICATED

(A) painful
(B) complex
(C) simplified
(D) plain

Q.16

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. Amphan, the more severe cyclone in the Bay of Bengal since the super cyclone of 1999, made landfall in the afternoon on Wednesday.

(A) since the super cyclone
(B) the more severe cyclone
(C) in the afternoon
(D) made landfall

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Just like a spider that spins its own web and later destroys it, human beings can also destroy the web of desires that "engulfs it".

(A) engulfs them
(B) engulfing it
(C) engulf it
(D) No substitution

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. DELECTABLE

(A) luscious
(B) horrible
(C) unpleasant
(D) offensive

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. With a lot of difficulty, he could _____ only two tickets for the train from Mumbai to Ranchi.

(A) procure
(B) gain
(C) incur
(D) attain

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Students in the sixth grade of a certain school in Navi Mumbai love (1)_____ History lessons, thanks to a novel teaching aid. It (2) _____ not surprising given the fact that their study material (3) _____ comic books and they use their textbooks for (4) _____ to put things into perspective. Besides, students are (5) _____ to tap other sources of information as well.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 1.

(A) her
(B) their
(C) them
(D) our

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Students in the sixth grade of a certain school in Navi Mumbai love (1)_____ History lessons, thanks to a novel teaching aid. It (2) _____ not surprising given the fact that their study material (3) _____ comic books and they use their textbooks for (4) _____ to put things into perspective. Besides, students are (5) _____ to tap other sources of information as well.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 2.

(A) were
(B) was
(C) are
(D) is

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Students in the sixth grade of a certain school in Navi Mumbai love (1)_____ History lessons, thanks to a novel teaching aid. It (2) _____ not surprising given the fact that their study material (3) _____ comic books and they use their textbooks for (4) _____ to put things into perspective. Besides, students are (5) _____ to tap other sources of information as well.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 3.

(A) is including
(B) includes
(C) include
(D) has included

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Students in the sixth grade of a certain school in Navi Mumbai love (1)_____ History lessons, thanks to a novel teaching aid. It (2) _____ not surprising given the fact that their study material (3) _____ comic books and they use their textbooks for (4) _____ to put things into perspective. Besides, students are (5) _____ to tap other sources of information as well.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 4.

(A) suggestion
(B) reference
(C) practice
(D) indication

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Students in the sixth grade of a certain school in Navi Mumbai love (1)_____ History lessons, thanks to a novel teaching aid. It (2) _____ not surprising given the fact that their study material (3) _____ comic books and they use their textbooks for (4) _____ to put things into perspective. Besides, students are (5) _____ to tap other sources of information as well.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 5.

(A) boosted
(B) encouraged
(C) heartened
(D) cheered

General Intelligence 16 questions

Q.1

Select the word-pair in which the two words are related in the same way as are the two words in the following word-pair. Bread : Wheat

(A) Sauce : Tomato
(B) Meal : Flour
(C) Book : Library
(D) Zoo : Animal

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some magicians are psychologists. All psychologists are tourists. Conclusions: I. All tourists are psychologists. II. All magicians are tourists.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. RIGHT : UGKKR : : CHAOS : ?

(A) FQREF
(B) FEFRQ
(C) FREFQ
(D) FFERQ

Q.9

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs that can sequentially replace the * signs and balance the given equation. 7 * 96 * 8 * 39 * 25 = 70

(A) ×, −, ÷, +
(B) ×, ÷, −, +
(C) +, ÷, −, ×
(D) −, ×, ÷, +

Q.10

Five of the following six numbers are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the number that is different from the rest. 8, 24, 125, 343, 1331, 2197

(A) 2197
(B) 1331
(C) 24
(D) 125

Q.14

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (3, 3, 11)

(A) (4, 5, 18)
(B) (5, 8, 26)
(C) (7, 11, 35)
(D) (6, 15, 47)

Q.15

Three of the following four number triads are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the one that is different.

(A) (3, 6, 9)
(B) (2, 4, 8)
(C) (1, 2, 1)
(D) (4, 8, 16)

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Dolphins : Click : : Jackals : ?

(A) Bleat
(B) Scream
(C) Squeak
(D) Howl

Q.18

In a certain code language, VIRTUE is written as XCBYAN. How will MODEST be written in that language?

(A) IJNYYS
(B) JISYNY
(C) INYJYS
(D) JISNYY

Q.19

If in a code language, DISK is coded as 65 and WIRE is coded as 53, then how will you code CELL?

(A) 46
(B) 32
(C) 76
(D) 82

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 27 : 702 : : 12 : ?

(A) 402
(B) 103
(C) 341
(D) 132

Q.21
Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
5, 9, 16, 31, 60, 119, ?

(A) 436
(B) 326
(C) 236
(D) 346

Q.22
Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. k l _ p n _ k l m p _ b _ l m _ n b k _ m p n b

(A) m, n, b, p, k, l
(B) k, l, m, n, b, p
(C) m, b, n, k, p, l
(D) n, m, b, l, p, k

Q.23
Rohit is three times the age of his son Rishabh. Five years ago, he was four times older than Rishabh. What is Rohit's age at present?

(A) 45 years
(B) 60 years
(C) 30 years
(D) 15 years

Q.24
Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) ULO
(B) ILO
(C) ENO
(D) UOD

Q.25
Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

(A) Horde
(B) Piglet
(C) Ambush
(D) Herd

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Who among the following is the author of 'The Brahma Sutra – The Philosophy of Spiritual life'?

(A) Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Sarojini Naidu
(D) Rajendra Prasad

Q.2
Which company invested ₹11,400 crores during the financial year 2019-2020 across its market payments and wholesale business units in India to strengthen its foothold in India?

(A) Apple Inc.
(B) Walmart Inc.
(C) eBay Inc.
(D) Amazon.com, Inc.

Q.3
Who became the Chief Justice of Jammu and Kashmir High Court in December 2020?

(A) Sanjib Banerjee
(B) Pankaj Mithal
(C) Hemant Kumar Pandey
(D) Umesh Sinha

Q.4
A mass of snow and ice that moves slowly under the influence of gravity along a confined course away from its place of accumulation is called a _____.

(A) lagoon
(B) glacier
(C) block mountain
(D) plateau

Q.5
Who among the following is one of the seven winners of the Young Champions of the Earth 2020 prize given by UNEP?

(A) Veer Vikram Singh
(B) Vidyut Mohan
(C) Suchi Chaudhary
(D) Khushi Chindaliya

Q.6
As of January 2021, how many Olympic medals did India win in the sport of field hockey?

(A) 9
(B) 12
(C) 11
(D) 8

Q.7
In 711 CE, Arab general _____ conquered Sind, which became a part of the Caliph's domain.

(A) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(B) Muhammad-Bin-Tughlaq
(C) Muhammad Bin Qasim
(D) Muhammad Ghori

Q.8
On which of the following days is World Computer Literacy Day observed?

(A) 5 June
(B) 2 December
(C) 13 May
(D) 30 September

Q.9
Which of the following recommends Minimum Support Prices for crops in India?

(A) Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices
(B) NITI Aayog
(C) Indian Council of Agricultural Research
(D) Fiscal Prudence Commission

Q.10
Who among the following was adjudged as the 'Player of the Series' in the Australia versus India T20I series played in December 2020?

(A) Matthew Wade
(B) T Natarajan
(C) Hardik Pandya
(D) Mitchell Swepson

Q.11
A message that tries to trick a person into providing information such as his social security number, bank account information or login username and password for a website is a type of malware called:

(A) Worms
(B) Zombie
(C) Macro Virus
(D) Phishing

Q.12
What is the molecular formula for hydrochloric acid?

(A) H_2SO_4
(B) HNO_3
(C) KOH
(D) HCl

Q.13
Mount Jopuno is situated in which of the following states?

(A) Uttarakhand
(B) Sikkim
(C) Andhra Pradesh
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.14
From which of the following sources does the brain get energy?

(A) Nucleic acids
(B) Fatty acids
(C) Amino acids
(D) Glucose

Q.15
Which of the following is the largest river island in India?

(A) Diu island
(B) Gundu island
(C) Divar island
(D) Majuli island

Q.16
What is the minimum age requirement for appointment as a Governor?

(A) 26 years
(B) 35 years
(C) 25 years
(D) 42 years

Q.17
Which of the following was included as an official Olympic sport in December 2020?

(A) Breakdancing
(B) Cricket
(C) Chess
(D) Bowling

Q.18
Who among the following was appointed as the Chairman of the National Stock Exchange (NSE) in December 2019?

(A) Girish Chandra Chaturvedi
(B) Vikramajit Sen
(C) Ashok Chawla
(D) Ashishkumar Chauhan

Q.19
Who was the President of the Indian National Congress when India won its freedom in the year 1947?

(A) Abul Kalam Azad
(B) Vallabhbhai Patel
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) J. B. Kripalani

Q.20
ISRO launched _____, it's 42nd communication satellite, in December 2020.

(A) CMS-01
(B) GSAT-31
(C) GSAT-30
(D) INSAT-4CR

Q.21
As of December 2020, under the Startup India Initiative, the monthly allowance for startups with women as founder/co-founder was _____ per month for a period of one year.

(A) ₹50,000
(B) ₹30,000
(C) ₹20,000
(D) ₹40,000

Q.22
Who among the following won the Golden Globe 2020 award for 'Best Performance by an Actor in a Motion Picture – Drama'?

(A) Lucas Hedges
(B) Joaquin Phoenix
(C) John David Washington
(D) Jonathan Pryce

Q.23
Which of the following is NOT one of the three parallel ranges of the Himalayas in its longitudinal extent?

(A) Shiwaliks
(B) Himshikha
(C) Himachal
(D) Himadri

Q.24
With which of the following musical instruments is the musician Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma associated?

(A) Dholak
(B) Sarangi
(C) Santoor
(D) Sarod

Q.25

Which of the following festivals is called the month of merits and is celebrated between May and June?

(A) Saga Dawa

(B) Bhanu Jaati

(C) Losar

(D) Losoong

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) partial

'Complete' means whole or entire; its opposite is 'partial'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) bitterness

The prisoner was upset and angry, so her voice carried 'bitterness', resentful anger.

Q.3 · Answer (B) play online games

'Spend time' is followed by a gerund: 'spend our time playing online games'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) convean

The correct spelling is 'convene'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) incorrigible

An incorrigible person cannot be corrected or reformed. 'Indelible' means that cannot be erased, 'infallible' never wrong and 'invincible' that cannot be defeated.

Q.6 · Answer (A) BADC

B introduces stories of people who overcame disabilities, A says their desire to succeed drove them, D says what they wanted to prove, and C ('This is what made...') gives an example of it: BADC.

Q.7 · Answer (C) hypocrite

A hypocrite claims morals or beliefs that he or she does not really hold.

Q.8 · Answer (C) The lawn is mowed once every month.

The simple present 'mow' becomes 'is mowed' in the passive: 'The lawn is mowed once every month.'

Q.9 · Answer (C) DBAC

D sets the scene (soldiers with torches round a ditch), B shows the two men fighting in it, A describes them covered in mud, and C, the sergeant's shout, ends it: DBAC.

Q.10 · Answer (D) the greatest kings

'One of the' takes a superlative and a plural noun: 'one of the greatest kings of India'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) distinguished

'Nondescript' means dull, with nothing distinctive; its opposite is 'distinguished'. 'Ordinary' and 'common' are near synonyms.

Q.12 · Answer (A) something good that isn’t recognised at first

'A blessing in disguise' is something good that at first seemed bad or went unrecognised.

Q.13 · Answer (D) The supervisor instructed the staff to make sure that every room was disinfected properly.

An order is reported with 'instructed ... to', and after the past reporting verb 'is disinfected' becomes 'was disinfected'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Something impossible to find

'A needle in a haystack' is something almost impossible to find.

Q.15 · Answer (B) complex

'Complicated' means 'complex'; 'simplified' and 'plain' are its opposites.

Q.16 · Answer (B) the more severe cyclone

'Since the super cyclone of 1999' compares it with every cyclone in that period, so it needs the superlative: 'the most severe cyclone'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) engulfs them

The pronoun refers to 'human beings', which is plural: 'the web of desires that engulfs them'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) luscious
'Delectable' means delicious or delightful: 'luscious'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) procure
To 'procure' is to obtain something, especially with effort, as tickets here. One 'incurs' costs or losses and 'attains' goals.

Q.21 · Answer (B) their
The students love 'their' History lessons: the possessive for 'students'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) is
'It' is singular and the passage is in the present: 'It is not surprising'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) includes
The singular subject 'their study material' takes 'includes', in the present like the rest of the sentence.

Q.24 · Answer (B) reference
The textbooks are used for 'reference': they look things up in them to put things into perspective.

Q.25 · Answer (B) encouraged
Students are 'encouraged' to tap other sources: urged and supported to do so. 'Boosted', 'heartened' and 'cheered' do not take 'to' and a verb in this sense.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (A) Sauce : Tomato
Bread is made from wheat, as sauce is made from tomatoes.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
All psychologists are tourists, but not all tourists need be psychologists (I fails); only the magicians who are psychologists must be tourists, and nothing is known of the rest (II fails).

Q.6 · Answer (D) FFERQ
The letters move +3, –2, +4, +3, –2: R → U, I → G, G → K, H → K, T → R. Likewise C → F, H → F, A → E, O → R, S → Q: FFERQ.

Q.9 · Answer (B) ×, ÷, –, +
$7 \times 96 \div 8 - 39 + 25 = 7 \times 12 - 39 + 25 = 84 - 39 + 25 = 70$.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 24
8, 125, 343, 1331 and 2197 are the cubes of the primes 2, 5, 7, 11 and 13. 24 is not a cube.

Q.14 · Answer (C) (7, 11, 35)
Twice the sum of the first two numbers, minus 1, gives the third: $2 \times (3 + 3) - 1 = 11$. Likewise $2 \times (7 + 11) - 1 = 35$; the other options give 17, 25 and 41, not 18, 26 and 47.

Q.15 · Answer (B) (2, 4, 8)
In (3, 6, 9), (1, 2, 1) and (4, 8, 16) the third number is the square of the first. In (2, 4, 8) it is 8, not $2^2 = 4$.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Howl
The sound a dolphin makes is a click, and a jackal's is a howl.

Q.18 · Answer (D) JISNYY
Each half of the word is reversed (VIR TUE → RIV EUT) and the letters then move +6 and –6 in turn, giving XCBYAN. MODEST → DOM TSE → D + 6, O – 6, M + 6, T – 6, S + 6, E – 6 = JISNYY.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 76
The code is the sum of the letters' positions counted from Z (Z = 1, A = 26): DISK = 23 + 18 + 8 + 16 = 65 and WIRE = 4 + 18 + 9 + 22 = 53. CELL = 24 + 22 + 15 + 15 = 76.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 132
The second number is the first times one less than itself: $27 \times 26 = 702$. Likewise $12 \times 11 = 132$.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 236

Each term is double the one before, minus 1 and minus 2 in turn: 5 × 2 − 1 = 9, 9 × 2 − 2 = 16, ... 60 × 2 − 1 = 119, so 119 × 2 − 2 = 236.

Q.22 · Answer (C) m, b, n, k, p, l

With m, b, n, k, p, l in the blanks the block klmpnb repeats: klmpnb klmpnb klmpnb klmpnb.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 45 years

SSC's key reads 'four times older' in its usual sense in these questions, four times as old. With Rishabh x and Rohit 3x: 3x − 5 = 4(x − 5), so x = 15 and Rohit is 45. (Read strictly as five times as old, it would give 30, also an option.)

Q.24 · Answer (D) UOD

ULO, ILO and ENO are vowel, consonant, vowel, each ending in O. UOD is vowel, vowel, consonant.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Piglet

Horde, ambush and herd are collective nouns (an ambush of tigers, a herd of cattle). A piglet is a young pig.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan

Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan wrote 'The Brahma Sutra: The Philosophy of Spiritual Life', a translation of the Brahma Sutra with his commentary.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Amazon.com, Inc.

According to regulatory filings reported in December 2020, Amazon put about ₹11,400 crore into its Indian marketplace (Amazon Seller Services), payments (Amazon Pay) and wholesale units in 2019-20.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Pankaj Mithal

Pankaj Mithal, a judge of the Allahabad High Court, was appointed Chief Justice of the High Court of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh on 31 December 2020, after Gita Mittal retired; he took oath on 4 January 2021.

Q.4 · Answer (B) glacier

A glacier is a mass of ice and snow that moves slowly downhill under its own weight, away from where it accumulated.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Vidyut Mohan

Vidyut Mohan, co-founder of Takachar, which turns crop residue into fuel and fertiliser, was one of UNEP's seven Young Champions of the Earth in 2020.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 11

India had won 11 Olympic medals in hockey: 8 gold, 1 silver (1960) and 2 bronze (1968, 1972).

Q.7 · Answer (C) Muhammad Bin Qasim

Muhammad bin Qasim, a general of the Umayyad Caliphate, conquered Sind in 711-712 CE.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 2 December

World Computer Literacy Day, started by NIIT in 2001, is observed on 2 December.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices

The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) recommends the MSPs; the government then announces them.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Hardik Pandya

Hardik Pandya was Player of the Series as India won the December 2020 T20I series in Australia 2-1.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Phishing

Phishing messages pose as a trusted source to trick people into giving away personal details such as bank or login information.

Q.12 · Answer (D) HCl
Hydrochloric acid is HCl. H_2SO_4 is sulphuric acid, HNO_3 nitric acid and KOH potassium hydroxide, a base.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Sikkim
Mount Jopuno is a peak in western Sikkim, in the Kangchenjunga region.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Glucose
The brain runs almost entirely on glucose carried by the blood.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Majuli island
Majuli, in the Brahmaputra in Assam, is the largest river island in India.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 35 years
Under Article 157 a Governor must be a citizen of India who has completed 35 years of age.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Breakdancing
In December 2020 the IOC added breaking (breakdancing) to the programme of the Paris 2024 Olympics.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Girish Chandra Chaturvedi
Girish Chandra Chaturvedi, a former Petroleum Secretary, became Chairman of the NSE's governing board in December 2019 with SEBI's approval.

Q.19 · Answer (D) J. B. Kripalani
J. B. Kripalani was President of the Congress at independence: he presided over the Meerut session of November 1946 and resigned in November 1947, when Rajendra Prasad succeeded him.

Q.20 · Answer (A) CMS-01
CMS-01, launched by PSLV-C50 on 17 December 2020, was ISRO's 42nd communication satellite.

Q.21 · Answer (C) ₹20,000
SSC's key gives ₹20,000: in December 2020 the Startup India portal's page for women entrepreneurs listed a monthly allowance of ₹20,000 for one year for startups with a woman founder or co-founder, under the Andaman & Nicobar Islands policy. It is a Union Territory's incentive shown on the portal, not a national Startup India grant.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Joaquin Phoenix
Joaquin Phoenix won the 2020 Golden Globe for Best Actor in a Motion Picture – Drama for 'Joker'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Himshikha
The Himalayas run in three parallel ranges: the Himadri (Greater), the Himachal (Lesser) and the Shiwaliks (Outer). 'Himshikha' is not one of them.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Santoor
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma was a santoor maestro, credited with making it a classical concert instrument.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Saga Dawa
Saga Dawa, the 'month of merits', falls in the fourth Tibetan lunar month (May-June) and marks the Buddha's birth, enlightenment and parinirvana; it is celebrated in Sikkim.

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